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SECURITY



Telecom giant Orange warns of disruption amid ongoing cyberattack

Lorenzo Franceschi-
Bicchierai

— 8:00 AM PDT · July 29,
2025

Orange, a French telecommunications giant and one of the largest phone providers in the world, [announced](#) on Monday that it was the victim of an unspecified cyberattack.

In the announcement, the company said that it detected a cyberattack “on one of its information systems” on July 25, and that it proceeded to “isolate potentially affected services and minimize any impact.”

The move to isolate affected systems, Orange added, caused disruptions to some of the company’s platforms, as well as business customers and some public sector services mostly in France, according to a translation of the statement. The announcement said that the solutions the company is implementing will gradually restore services by Wednesday, and that “there is no evidence to suggest that any internal or customer data has been exfiltrated.”

Orange did not respond to TechCrunch’s request for comment, which included questions about the nature of the cyberattack, and whether the company has the technical means to detect any data exfiltration.

The company said in the announcement that it is engaging and informing affected customers, and filed a complaint with “relevant authorities,” without providing specifics. Companies in Europe that are

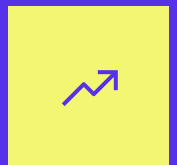
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subject to GDPR, the bloc's data protection rules, are required to notify their local data protection authorities within three days of a suspected data breach.

Orange serves 291 million customers worldwide, across 26 different countries, and has 127,000 employees, [according to the company](#).

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Citizen Lab director warns cyber industry

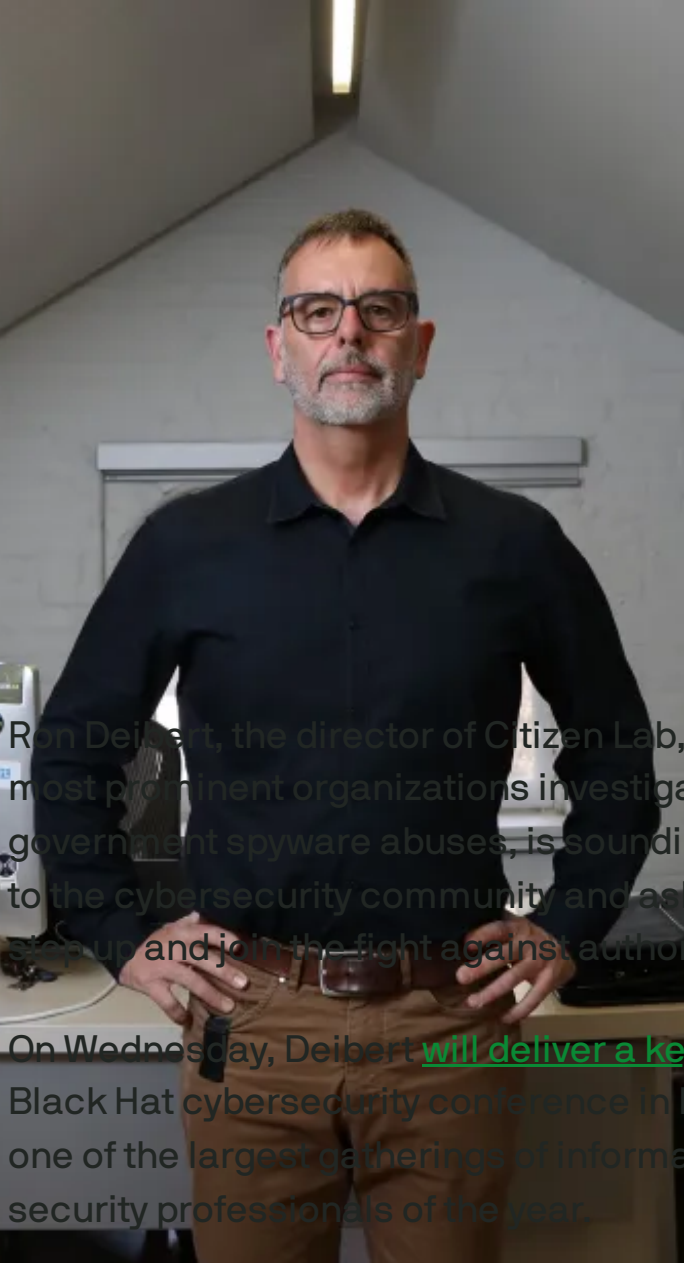


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about US authoritarian descent

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

8:01 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Ron Deibert, the director of Citizen Lab, one of the most prominent organizations investigating government spyware abuses, is sounding the alarm to the cybersecurity community and asking them to step up and join the fight against authoritarianism.

On Wednesday, Deibert [will deliver a keynote](#) at the Black Hat cybersecurity conference in Las Vegas, one of the largest gatherings of information security professionals of the year.

Ahead of his talk, Deibert told TechCrunch that he plans to speak about what he describes as a “descent into a kind of fusion of tech and fascism,” and the role that the Big Tech platforms are playing, and “propelling forward a really frightening type of collective insecurity that isn’t typically addressed by this crowd, this community, as a cybersecurity problem.”

Deibert described the recent political events in the United States as a “dramatic descent into authoritarianism,” but one that the cybersecurity community can help defend against.

“I think alarm bells need to be rung for this community that, at the very least, they should be

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aware of what’s going on and hopefully they can not contribute to it, if not help reverse it,” Deibert told TechCrunch.

Historically, at least in the United States, the cybersecurity industry has put politics — to a certain extent — to the side. More recently, however, politics has fully entered the world of cybersecurity.

Earlier this year, President Donald Trump [ordered an investigation into former CISA director Chris Krebs](#), who had publicly rebuffed Trump’s false claims about election fraud by declaring the 2020 election secure. Trump later [fired Krebs by tweet](#). The investigation ordered by Trump months after his 2024 reelection forced Krebs to [step down from SentinelOne and vow to fight back](#).

In response, Jen Easterly, another former CISA director and Krebs’ successor, [called on the cybersecurity community to get involved](#) and speak out.

“If we stay silent when experienced, mission-driven leaders are sidelined or sanctioned, we risk something greater than discomfort; we risk diminishing the very institutions we are here to protect,” Easterly wrote in a post on LinkedIn.

Easterly was herself [a victim of political pressure](#) from the Trump administration when her offer to join West Point was rescinded in late July.

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Deibert, who this year [published his new book](#), “Chasing Shadows: Cyber Espionage, Subversion,

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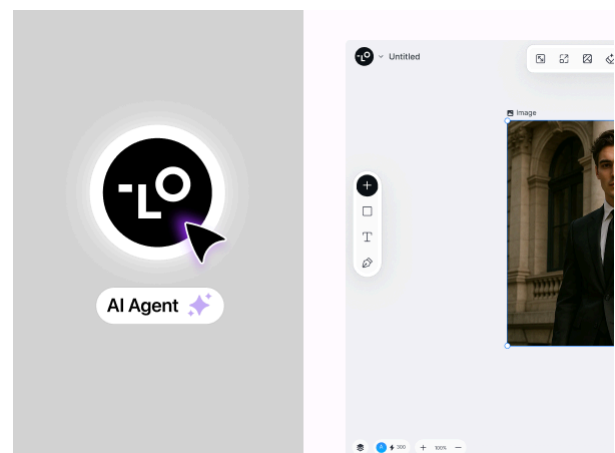
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and the Global Fight for Democracy,” is echoing the same message as Easterly.

“I think that there comes a point at which you have to recognize that the landscape is changing around you, and the security problems you set out for yourselves are maybe trivial in light of the broader context and the insecurities that are being propelled forward in the absence of proper checks and balances and oversight, which are deteriorating,” said Deibert.

Deibert is also concerned that big companies like Meta, Google, and Apple could take a step back in their efforts to fight against government spyware — [sometimes referred](#) to as “commercial” or “mercenary” spyware — by gutting their threat intelligence teams.

These threat intelligence teams are dedicated groups of security researchers that track government hackers, both those working inside government agencies, such as China’s Ministry of State Security or Russia’s intelligence agencies FSB and GRU, and companies such as NSO Group or Paragon.

These are the same teams that are responsible for detecting hacks against their own users, such as when [WhatsApp caught NSO Group](#) hacking more than 1,400 of its users in 2019, or when Apple caught hackers using government spyware to target its customers and [notified the victims](#) of the [attacks](#).

Deibert believes there is a “huge market failure when it comes to cybersecurity for global civil society,” a part of the population that generally cannot afford to get help from big security companies that typically serve governments and corporate clients. “This market failure is going to get more acute as supporting institutions

evaporate and attacks on civil society amplify,” he said.

“Whatever they can do to contribute to offset this market failure (e.g., pro bono work) will be essential to the future of liberal democracy worldwide,” he said.

Deibert is concerned that these threat intelligence teams could be cut or at least reduced, given that the same companies have cut their moderation and

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Data breach at French telecom giant Bouygues affects millions of customers

Zack Whittaker — 6:45 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

Bouygues Telecom, the third-largest phone carrier in France, has confirmed a cyberattack and data breach affecting millions of its customers.

In [a statement posted to its website](#), the telecommunications giant said the hack allowed the intruders to access the personal information on 6.4 million customer accounts. Bouygues said it detected the cyberattack on August 4, but did not

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give a time frame for when the breach was remediated.

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In [a separate page](#) dedicated to victims of the cyberattack, Bouygues said the stolen data includes customers' contact information and contractual data, their civil status (or company data if the subscriber is a professional), as well as IBANs, or international bank account numbers.

Bouygues said it has about 26.9 million mobile customers.

The cyberattack has been reported to France's data protection agency, CNIL.

At the time of publication, Bouygues' [web page](#) about the cyberattack contained a hidden "noindex" tag in its source code, which instructs search engines to ignore the page, making it difficult for anyone searching the web to find the page.

A spokesperson for Bouygues did not immediately respond to a request for comment asking for details about the cyberattack, or explain why the page was hidden from search engines.

News of the breach comes soon after [a cyberattack at French telecom giant Orange](#), the country's largest phone carrier and one of the largest telecommunication companies in the world. On July 29, Orange told customers to expect disruption as it moved to "isolate potentially affected services." Orange serves more than 290 million customers worldwide.

Zack Whittaker - 15 hours ago

SECURITY



TeaOnHer, a rival Tea app for men, is leaking users' personal data and driver's licenses

Amanda Silberling,
Zack Whittaker
- 1 day ago

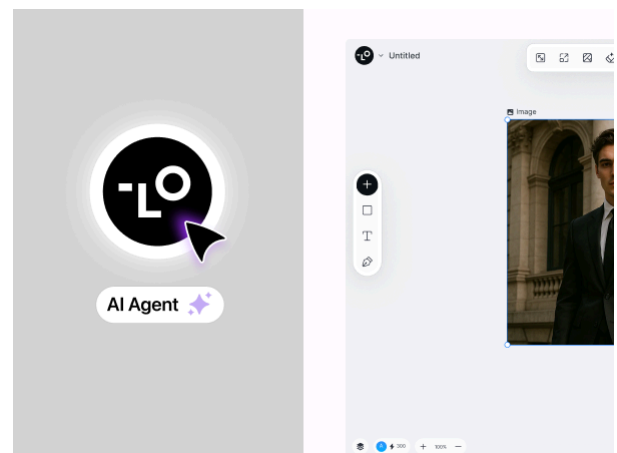
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Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai
- 2 days ago

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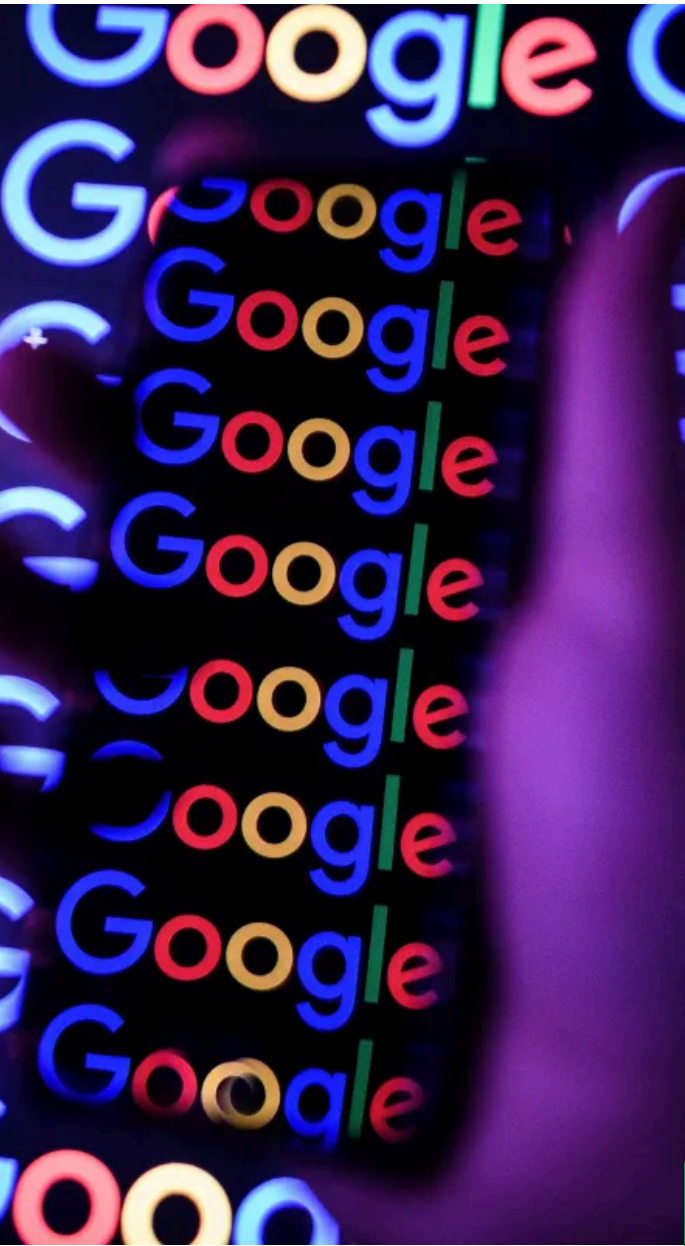
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Zack Whittaker is the security editor at TechCrunch. He can be reached via encrypted message at...

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Google says hackers stole its customers' data by breaching its Salesforce database

Zack Whittaker — 5:05 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

information has been stolen in a recent breach of one of its databases.

In [a blog post](#) late on Tuesday, Google Threat Intelligence Group said one of its Salesforce database systems, used to store contact information and related notes for small and medium-sized businesses, was breached by a hacking group popularly known as ShinyHunters, formally designated as UNC6040.

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“The data retrieved by the threat actor was confined to basic and largely publicly available business information, such as business names and contact details,” the company said.

Google did not disclose how many customers are affected, and Google spokesperson Mark Karayan declined to comment beyond the company’s blog post. It’s not clear if the company has received any communication, such as a ransom demand.

ShinyHunters is known for targeting big companies and their cloud-based databases.

This is the latest in a series of breaches targeting Salesforce cloud systems, after recent thefts of [customer data from Cisco](#) and [airline giant Qantas](#), [retail giant Pandora](#), among others, as [reported by Bleeping Computer](#). According to Google’s blog post, the ShinyHunters group relies on voice phishing techniques to trick company employees into granting them access to their cloud-based Salesforce databases.

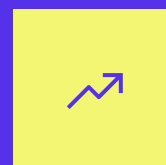
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Google said the ShinyHunters group is likely preparing a data leak site, which some ransomware gangs use to publish stolen data to [extort their corporate victims](#) into paying a ransom. The group is said to have overlaps with other groups, [including The Com](#), a known collective of cybercriminals who use hacking, extortion, and sometimes threats of violence to break into networks.

Do you know more about the Google data breach? Have you been notified by Google? Securely contact this reporter via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337](#) on Signal.

Updated with response from Google.

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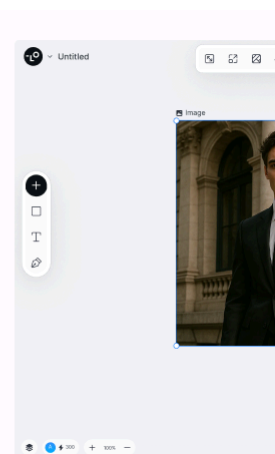
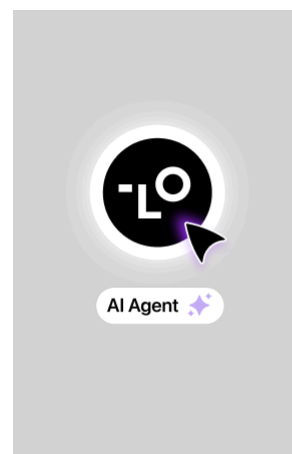


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